

it lacks a seamless app continuity – switching from the rear display to the main screen doesn't resume from where you left off, and users need to unlock the phone and reopen the camera app on the front. This breaks the flow a bit and could be improved with smoother transitions between the two displays.

Additionally, while the display handles notifications and basic widgets well, it lacks the finesse of flagship foldables with similar features. For example, the display doesn't offer a real-time preview when taking photos of other people, so it misses out on a potential interactive function. Overall, while the secondary display is innovative and visually appealing, its practical benefits feel a bit limited, and it could become even more useful with updates to software functionality and seamless continuity. Nevertheless, the combination of a primary high-resolution screen with the secondary rear display is innovative, but the mediocre display brightness is a real pain point.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Under the hood, the Lava Agni 3 is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 7300X processor which is capable of competing with mid-range heavyweights, handling most day-to-day tasks and moderate gaming with relative ease. It supports 14 5G bands, putting it on par with other devices in its category and ensuring smooth connectivity for users who want to leverage 5G networks.

However, when it comes to graphics performance, the Agni 3 lags behind competitors like the Nothing Phone (2a) and OnePlus Nord CE4, particularly in GPU benchmarks where the difference is noticeable in graphically demanding apps or games.

On the software front, the Lava Agni 3 shines with its clean, bloatware-free experience running Android 14. Lava has committed to providing three major Android updates and four years of security patches, which is a promising offering in this price range.

Users who prioritise a clean software experience without intrusive ads will find

this device to be a breath of fresh air. The OS itself is intuitive and smooth, with little to no lag in general navigation.

Overall, the Lava Agni 3 provides a reliable experience for standard tasks, although it may not satisfy users looking for high performance in gaming or intensive multitasking. It's a device better suited for users who value a clean software environment and are willing to compromise slightly on graphics-heavy performance.

CAMERA

The Lava Agni 3 offers a versatile camera setup. On paper, it has a 50 MP primary sensor, an 8 MP telephoto lens with 3x optical zoom, and an 8 MP ultrawide sensor, along with a 16 MP front camera for selfies. In bright lighting conditions, the primary camera captures images with accurate colours and good dynamic range, though the quality noticeably drops as lighting decreases, even by a bit.

In moderately low light, images show signs of noise, especially on the ultrawide and telephoto cameras. The main camera also exhibits shutter lag in low light, which can lead to blurry images, making it a less reliable option for night photography.

Portrait mode photos are decent, maintaining a good colour profile, but the noise issue persists when light levels are less than ideal. Additionally, video recording is limited, with only the rear camera supporting 4K resolution, while the front camera maxes out at 1080p.

While the Agni 3's camera setup looks impressive on paper, its performance is inconsistent, particularly in challenging lighting. Those who want superior camera performance would be better off opting for the Motorola Edge 50 Neo.

BATTERY LIFE

The Lava Agni 3's battery life is adequate but falls short when compared to its peers. In the PCMark Battery Test, the phone lasted 12 hours and 8 minutes, a respectable result but still outperformed by competitors like the OnePlus Nord CE4, which offers superior battery endurance. This difference is noticeable in real-world usage, with the Agni 3's battery draining faster during heavy tasks like

gaming or prolonged use of 5G. However, the phone compensates somewhat with its 66W fast charging support, which can take the device from 0 to 100% in around 47-48 minutes. Unfortunately, the base model of the Lava Agni 3 does not include a charger in the box, requiring users to pay an additional ₹2,000 to get one. This feels like a drawback, especially given the phone's positioning in the mid-range category where most phones include a charger in the box.

VERDICT

I'd like to start off by giving props to Lava and their intention behind the Lava Agni 3. They intended to make a device that doesn't stick to the status quo and ventures more premium and innovative features like the secondary AMOLED display. The phone also brings an Apple-like Action Button to the masses. Add to that clean software and decent performance for everyday tasks, and the Lava Agni 3 seems very enticing. However, it falls short in crucial areas such as camera quality, outdoor display brightness, and battery life, making it hard to recommend over similarly priced competitors like the Motorola Edge 50 Neo, Nothing Phone (2a) or OnePlus Nord CE4. While the innovative design and bloatware-free OS will appeal to certain users, the compromises in durability, camera output, and battery endurance make this device a less compelling choice unless design and software are your top priorities.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7300X | GPU: Mali-G615 MC2 | OS: Android 14 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR5 | Storage: 256 GB UFS 3.1 | Display: 6.78" AMOLED, 1200 x 2652 pixels, 120 Hz, 1B colours | Secondary Display: 1.74" AMOLED, 336 x 480 pixels | IP Rating: IP64 | Cameras: 50 MP Primary + 8 MP Telephoto (3x) + 8 MP Ultrawide | Front Camera: 16 MP | Video: 4K@30fps (rear), 1080p@30fps (front) | Battery Capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 66 W | Colours: Heather Glass, Pristine Glass | Weight: 212 g | Thickness: 8.8 mm

CONTACT

Company: LAVA | Phone: 1860-500-5001 | Email: Web form | Website: <https://www.lavamobiles.com/>